

Absolutely — **most** is a very useful grammar/polyfunctionality target because your passage uses it here:

> “**Most** of these plants are grown on the rooftop of her house...”

Here **most** means **the majority / the largest part of a specific group**. But **most** also works as a determiner, pronoun, adverb in superlatives, and in several important fixed patterns.

Word family: **most / mostly / utmost**

Base word: most

Related form: mostly

Useful related form: utmost

Part of speech: determiner (限定詞) / pronoun (代名詞) / adverb (副詞)

Your sentence:

> “**Most** of these plants are grown on the rooftop of her house.”

Meaning in your passage: **most of + specific plural noun/pronoun** — 大部分 ; 多數

Here **most** means:

> **the majority of a particular, already identified group.**

繁體中文 :

某個特定群體中的大部分 / 多數

Natural translation:

> “Most of these plants are grown on the rooftop of her house.”

「**這些植物大部分**都種在她家的天台上。」

So here:

> **most of these plants = 這些植物中的大部分**

1. **most + plural noun (泛指大多數)** — 大多數 ; 大部分

No **of** when speaking generally.

Practice 1

> “**Most plants** need light.”

「**大多數植物**都需要陽光。」

Practice 2

> “Most people enjoy some form of music.”

「**大多數人**都喜歡某種形式的音樂。」

****most + plural noun = 某類人 / 事物整體中的大多數，泛指而非特定群體****

Important:

> ****most people**** 

> ****most of people**** 

2. ****most + uncountable noun (大部分某物) — 大部分****

Practice 3

> “**Most water** on Earth is salty.”

「地球上的**大部分水**都是鹹水。」

Practice 4

> “Most information is now stored digitally.”

「現在**大部分資訊**都以數碼方式儲存。」

****most + uncountable noun = 某類不可數事物中的大部分****

3. ****most of + the/these/those/possessive/pronoun (特定群體) —中的大部分****

This is your exact source pattern.

Practice 5 — Original

> “**Most of these plants** are grown on the rooftop.”

「**這些植物中的大部分**都種在天台上。」

Practice 6

> “Most of my friends live nearby.”

「我的朋友中**大部分**都住在附近。」

Practice 7

> “Most of them were ready.”

「他們**大部分**都準備好了。」

****most of = 某個已特定、已限定群體中的大部分****

Common:

* most of the students

* most of these plants

* most of my time

* most of them

4. ****most = the majority, pronoun use — 大多數；大部分****

No noun follows.

Practice 8

> “Some plants need shade, but ****most**** prefer sunlight.”

「有些植物需要陰涼，但****大多數****偏好陽光。」

Practice 9

> “Most were satisfied with the result.”

「****大多數人****都對結果感到滿意。」

****most — pronoun = 已知群體中的大多數人 / 事物****

5. **most = greatest amount / degree — 最多；最大部分**

Practice 10

> “Which plant needs the **most** water?”

「哪種植物需要**最多**水？」

Practice 11

> “She spends most on gardening supplies.”

「她在園藝用品上花的錢**最多**。」

most = 在數量、程度或份量上最高

This is the opposite of **least**.

6. **the most + adjective/adverb (最高級) — 最……的；最……地**

A major grammar function.

Practice 12

> “This is the **most beautiful** flower in the garden.”

「這是花園裡**最漂亮的**花。」

Practice 13

> “She works **most carefully** with young plants.”

「她照顧幼苗時做得**最仔細**。」

the most + adjective/adverb = 在某群體中程度最高

Used especially with longer adjectives/adverbs:

* most beautiful

* most useful

* most carefully

7. **most + adjective/adverb (正式強調) — 非常；極其**

This is easy to miss.

Practice 14

> “That was a **most interesting** talk.”

「那是一場**非常有趣的**演講。」

Practice 15

> “She was most helpful.”

「她**非常樂於助人 / 幫了很大的忙**。」

most + adjective = very / extremely

Important:

without **the**, this can mean **very**, not superlative.

Compare:

> **the most interesting book**

> = 最有趣的書

> **a most interesting book**

> = 一本非常有趣的書

Excellent MCQ material.

8. **most = to the greatest degree (最)**

As an adverb.

Practice 16

> “What I value **most** is honesty.”

「我**最**重視的是誠實。」

Practice 17

> “She enjoys gardening most in spring.”

「她在春天**最**喜歡做園藝。」

most = 在程度上最高 / 最強

9. **most** = almost all / nearly all in certain expressions — 幾乎全部；差不多所有

This is often contextual rather than a fully separate meaning.

Practice 18

> “For **most of the day**, she was outside.”

「她**大半天**都在外面。」

Practice 19

> “He spent **most of his life** abroad.”

「他一生中**大部分時間**都在海外。」

most of + time/period = 某段時間的大部分

10. **at most** = no more than — 最多；至多

A major fixed expression.

Practice 20

> “The task will take two hours **at most**.”

「這項工作**最多**需要兩小時。」

Practice 21

> “There were twenty people **at most**.”

「現場**最多**只有二十人。」

at most = 不超過某個數量 / 程度

Opposite:

> at least = 至少

11. **for the most part = mostly / generally — 大體上；大部分情況下**

Practice 22

> “The plants are, **for the most part**, healthy.”

「這些植物**大體上**都很健康。」

Practice 23

> “The project was successful for the most part.”

「這個項目**整體而言 / 大致上**是成功的。」

for the most part = 大部分情況下；整體而言

12. **make the most of + opportunity/resource — 充分利用**

A very important fixed expression, and your passage actually contains it elsewhere:

> “She has made the most of every bit of space.”

Practice 24

> “She **made the most of** the small balcony.”

「她**充分利用**了那個小露台。」

Practice 25

> “We should make the most of our time.”

「我們應該**充分利用**時間。」

make the most of = 盡量充分利用某個機會、資源、時間或條件

This is a fixed expression, not just the ordinary quantity meaning.

13. **mostly = mainly / generally — 主要地；大多數情況下**

A major related adverb.

Practice 26

> “The garden is **mostly** used for vegetables.”

「這個花園**主要**用來種蔬菜。」

Practice 27

> “The audience was mostly young people.”

「觀眾**大多數**是年輕人。」

mostly = 主要地；大部分情況下；大多數由……構成

14. **mostly = almost entirely — 幾乎全部**

Practice 28

> “The sky was mostly clear.”

「天空**大致上 / 幾乎都是**晴朗的。」

Practice 29

> “The soil is mostly dry.”

「泥土**大部分**已經乾了。」

mostly = 某狀況佔絕大部分，但不是百分之百

15. **utmost = greatest possible degree — 最大限度的；極度的**

A useful related lexical form, though not a simple inflection.

Practice 30

> “The plants were handled with the **utmost care**.”

「這些植物受到**極其細心 / 最大程度的謹慎**照料。」

Practice 31

> “Safety is of the utmost importance.”

「安全是**極其重要的**。」

utmost = 可能達到的最高程度；最大限度的

Common:

* utmost care

* utmost importance

* utmost respect

Important distinction: **most vs most of**

This is the biggest grammar contrast.

most + noun

general category:

> “Most students like holidays.”

「大多數學生都喜歡假期。」

most of + determiner/pronoun

specific group:

> “Most of the students in my class like holidays.”

「我班上的學生大部分都喜歡假期。」

So:

> **most students** 

> **most of the students** 

> **most of students** 

Important distinction: **most vs almost**

most

= 大多數 / 最多 / 最

almost

= 幾乎

> “Most students passed.”

= 大多數學生合格。

> “Almost all students passed.”

= 幾乎所有學生都合格。

Do not confuse:

> **most people** ≠ **almost people** ❌

Important distinction: **most vs mostly**

most

determiner/pronoun/adverb:

> most people

> most of them

> like it most

mostly

adverb:

> mostly sunny

> mostly students

So:

> **Most people came.**

> = 大多數人來了。

> ****The guests were mostly students.****

> = 客人大多是學生。

Important distinction: ****most vs the most****

****most****

can mean majority:

> “Most plants need light.”

****the most****

often superlative:

> “This plant needs the most light.”

= 這棵植物需要最多光。

Article changes the function.

Important distinction: ****most interesting vs the most interesting****

Crucial.

****the most interesting****

= 最有趣的

> “This is the most interesting book.”

****a most interesting****

= 非常有趣的 , formal

> “That was a most interesting book.”

So:

> ****the most = superlative****

> ****most without the in formal emphasis = very****

Important distinction: **most** vs **majority**

most

more natural everyday grammar.

> “Most people agreed.”

the majority of

more formal/statistical.

> “The majority of respondents agreed.”

Both can mean 「大多數」, but **majority** normally requires a countable group and sounds more formal.

Important distinction: **most** vs **many**

many

= a large number.

most

= more than half / the majority.

> “Many students passed.”

= 很多學生合格。

> “Most students passed.”

= 大多數學生合格。

Most is stronger and more specific proportionally.

Important distinction: **most** vs **all**

most

= 大部分，但不是全部。

all

= 全部。

> “Most plants survived.”

does not mean:

> “All plants survived.”

Important distinction: **most vs more**

more

comparative:

= 更多

most

superlative:

= 最多

> more water

> = 更多水

> the most water

> = 最多水

Important distinction: **at most vs at least**

at most

= no more than

= 最多 / 至多

at least

= no less than

= 至少

> at most 10

> ≤ 10

> at least 10

> ≥ 10

Excellent MCQ pair.

Important distinction: **mostly vs generally**

mostly

= in the majority of cases / mainly.

generally

= usually / broadly speaking.

They overlap, but:

> “The group is mostly women.”

means composition.

> “People generally agree.”

means broad tendency.

Important distinction: **make the most of vs use**

use

neutral:

= 使用

make the most of

= use something as effectively/fully as possible.

> “She uses the balcony.”

VS

> “She makes the most of the balcony.”

The second implies ****充分利用、發揮到最大價值****.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * ****most + plural noun**** = 大多數.....
- * ****most + uncountable noun**** = 大部分.....
- * ****most of + specific group**** =中的大部分
- * ****most — pronoun**** = 大多數
- * ****most — greatest amount**** = 最多
- * ****the most + adjective/adverb**** = 最.....
- * ****most + adjective, formal**** = 非常 / 極其
- * ****most — adverb degree**** = 最
- * ****at most**** = 最多 / 至多
- * ****for the most part**** = 大體上
- * ****make the most of**** = 充分利用
- * ****mostly — mainly**** = 主要地 / 大多數
- * ****mostly — almost entirely**** = 大部分 / 幾乎全是
- * ****utmost**** = 最大限度 / 極其

This is primarily a ****grammar/polyfunctionality word****, not a huge lexical-polysemy word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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most + plural noun	某類可數人 / 事物整體中的大多數
most + uncountable noun	某類不可數事物中的大部分
most of + specific group	某個已限定群體 / 事物中的大部分
most — pronoun	已知群體中的大多數人 / 事物
most — quantity	數量、程度或份量最高；最多
the most + adjective/adverb	在比較範圍中程度最高；最.....
most + adjective — formal	非常、極其
most — adverb	在程度上最高；最
at most	不超過某個數量 / 程度；至多
for the most part	大部分情況下；大體而言

make the most of	把某個機會、資源或條件盡量充分利用	
mostly	主要地；大部分情況下；多數由.....構成	
utmost	可能達到的最大程度 / 最高限度	

For your original sentence

> **“**Most of these plants** are grown on the rooftop of her house...”**

The exact meaning is:

****most of = 這一組已經提到的植物當中，大部分 / 多數****

So naturally:

> ****「這些植物大部分都種在她家的天台上。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****most plants**** → 大多數植物，泛指
- > ****most of these plants**** → 這些特定植物中的大部分
- > ****most**** → 大多數 / 最多 / 最
- > ****the most beautiful**** → 最漂亮
- > ****a most beautiful garden**** → 非常漂亮的花園
- > ****mostly**** → 主要地 / 大多數情況下
- > ****at most**** → 最多
- > ****make the most of**** → 充分利用